and the blockade formally ended on 20 November, when US forces worldwide began returning to their normal readiness postures.

No evidence has emerged to suggest that Khrushchev or the Presidium gave serious consideration to the problem of handing over nuclear weapons to the Cuban army until Mikoyan raised it with the Presidium on 22 November, ahead of his meeting with Castro the following day. Anastas proposed telling Fidel that it would not be possible to transfer the nuclear warheads because there was an unpublished Soviet law that forbade their transfer to other states. [87] *The Soviet Cuban Missile Crisis* recounts how Mikoyan succeeded in persuading Castro to give up on the nuclear-armed Lunas (although the Cubans retained conventionally armed missiles that were part of the original Operation Anadyr). The Lunas did not arouse Castro's emotions in the same way as the Ilyushin-28s (which had raised public questions about Cuba's political status). So Anastas Mikoyan lied (perhaps a better word is fibbed). Castro did not ask him the obvious question – if it was illegal to transfer nuclear weapons to another state, why did Khrushchev intend to break Soviet law by first promising Cuba the nuclear missiles?

The prospect of Soviet tactical nuclear weapons in Cuba was not subject to systematic estimative scrutiny within the US intelligence community. Although the US military believed the Ilyushin-28s and the Lunas (first photographed on 25 October) were nuclear-capable, they did not know they were to be nuclear-armed. McNamara was unmoved by the Joint Chiefs' requests to equip dual-capable Honest John rockets, earmarked for the invasion, with nuclear warheads. The possibility that an invasion might face attacks from tactical nuclear weapons naturally exercised the Joint Chiefs. Yet, it did not cause them to reconsider the wisdom of an invasion, which they anticipated would proceed on Monday, 29 or Tuesday, 30 October. They nevertheless decided on Monday to review their plans in the light of the discovery of the dual-capable Lunas (they remained wholly unaware of the eighty nuclear-armed cruise missiles). In short, the Joint Chiefs were not deterred by the prospect of nuclear war in Cuba but intended to win one if called upon. Did Kennedy factor the missiles into his calculations about an